

HITANSHU PANDIT

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Summary:

Applied microeconomist specializing in quantitative analysis and policy evaluation, currently serving as a Post-Doctoral Research Fellow at Northeastern University. Expertise lies in utilizing econometric techniques and large datasets to address complex research questions in areas such as labor economics, healthcare, and urban policy. Proficient in a range of statistical, programming and visualization tools using Big Data. Actively involved in developing and implementing data-driven assessment strategies for the Summer Youth Employment Program in Boston, leading to significant increases in application and hiring rates. Prior experience includes collaborating with the North Carolina Department of Health and Human Services to evaluate the cost-effectiveness of mental health programs. Seeking a challenging role where I can apply my analytical skills and research experience to inform policy decisions and improve program outcomes.

Education:

Post-Doctoral Research Fellow, *July 2023-Continuing*
School of Public Policy and Urban Affairs, Northeastern University, Boston

Ph.D. in Economics, *June 2023*
Dissertation: Mobile-device locations and Labor Markets
Department of Economics, University of North Carolina, Greensboro

M.A. Economics, *2018*
School of Economics, Central University of Kerala, India

B.Sc.(Hons.) Mathematics, *2014*
University of Delhi, India

Research Experience and Other Employment:

Postdoc Fellow to Prof. Alicia S. Modestino - [2023 - Present]

- Develop and execute data-driven assessment strategies for the Summer Youth Employment Program 2023, 2024 and 2025. Integrating application information from employer partners and MA-Department of Elementary & Secondary Education data to generate meaningful performance insights for City of Boston - Office of Youth Employment and Opportunity to increase the application rate by around 10% each year.

* Empirical Methods Used: Two-Stage Least Squares (Instrumental Variables), Difference-in-Differences design using cross-cohort comparisons and Randomized Control Trial (Pilot).

Research Associate to Prof. Jeremy W. Bray - [2021 - 2023]

- Worked closely with the North Carolina Department of Health and Human Services to coordinate data-sharing agreements. Additionally, communicate results for the estimated cost savings of around \$3,000 per month per youth from mental health policy (High Fidelity Wraparound and Tried Care Coordination Program) in North Carolina using Medicaid claims and encounters data.

* Empirical Methods Used: Synthetic Control Methods (Augmented & General), Staggered Difference-in-Differences design using cross-cohort comparisons for non-linear outcomes.

Research Assistant to Prof. Martin S. Andersen - [Summer 2021]

- Processed and analyzed the Mobile-Device data (Big Data) providing monthly foot traffic information for around 5 million establishments in the United States.

Teaching Associate at Department of Economics, University of North Carolina, Greensboro - [2019-2021]

- Designed and delivered undergraduate courses in Business Statistics and Principles of Microeconomics, managing class sizes of approximately 90 students per semester. Successfully transitioned the curriculum from in-person to online formats during the COVID-19 pandemic, leveraging innovative approaches to enhance the learning experience for students.

Skills:

- R, Python, STATA, SQL/Snowflakes, Mathematica, Matlab
- Causal Inference, Econometric/Statistical Analysis (linear and non-linear), Cost-effectiveness analysis, Machine Learning (Supervised and Unsupervised).
- rMarkdown , $\LaTeX$, Git, Tableau

Research Papers:

City Limits: The relationship between employment and minimum wage using mobile-device locations (*Under Review*)

Crossing Borders and Changing Lives: Evaluating the labor market response when local areas change minimum wage (*Draft available on request*)

Simply can't wait: Evaluating the effect of voluntary employer minimum wage increase on local labor markets

Evaluating Equity in Healthcare from FQHC using Mobile Device Location Data (*With Nana B. Addai*)

Conditional Cash Transfer Programs: What Can We Learn from Summer Learn and Earn Programs? (*With Alicia S. Modestino, Mindy Marks & Hanna Hoover*)

Where the Rubber Meets the Road: Examining Inequities in Summer Youth Employment Programs (*With Alicia S. Modestino, Mindy Marks & Hanna Hoover*)

Technical Reports:

Estimating the Cost Savings of High-Fidelity Wraparound: Evidence from North Carolina (*With Jeremy Bray, Zubab Moid*) - Submitted to the DHHS, NC

Estimating the Cost Savings of Tiered Care Coordination for At-Risk Youth: Evidence from North Carolina (*With Jeremy Bray, Will Queen, Zubab Moid*) - Submitted to the DHHS, NC

Assessing the Effectiveness of In-School Workshops on Youth Application and Onboarding Rates for the SuccessLink Summer Jobs Program - Submitted to the OYEO, Boston

Professional Activities:

Reviewer Service: Southern Economics Journal, Economics of Education Review, Journal of Development Economics

Conference presentations: Carolina Region Empirical Economics Day, Charleston, SC, May 2022
Western Economic Association, Portland, OR, June 2022
3 Minutes Thesis, UNC, Greensboro, Oct 2022
Rising Scholars Conference at Chicago Booth, Virtual, Nov 2022
Southern Economic Association, Fort Lauderdale, FL, Nov 2022
Southeastern Micro Labor Workshop, Athens, GA, March 2023
National Institute of Technology, Surathkal, KA, India Dec 2023
GAP Policy Seminar, Northeastern University, Boston Jan 2024
Southern Economic Association, Washington DC, Nov 2024
C2C Policy Research Seminar, Northeastern University, Boston, Jan 2025

Discussant: Western Economic Association, June 2022
Southern Economic Association, Nov 2022
Southern Economic Association, Nov 2024

Other Services: International student Ambassador (2021) at International Programs Center, UNC, Greensboro, Co-organize research discussion series for Ph.D. students at Northeastern University (With Ariel Gomez)

Honors, Affiliations, Scholarships, and Fellowships:

[Experiential PhD Certificate](#) - Northeastern University, Boston - [2024-25]
[Global Action for Policy](#) - Research Affiliate - [2024 - Present]
[NULab](#) - Research Affiliate - [2024 - Present]
Arnold Ventures - Professional Development Grant - [2024]
Kathleen Price and Joseph M. Bryan Fellowship - [2022-23]
Graduate School Association UNCG - Professional Development Grant - [2022]
University Grant Commission Merit Scholarship, Govt. of India - [2016-18]
CBSE - CSSS Merit Scholarship, Govt. of India - [2011-14]

References:

Dr. Martin Sparre Andersen (Chair)
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The University of North Carolina at Greensboro
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